



Could you help me establish a secondary brand voice that is specific to our marketing copy and campaigns? the voice is good for the website but I think it needs to be less stuffy for ads and marketing. Can you start by establishing an alternative voice for the service offerings

Love this direction. Before we dive in, a few quick questions to nail the brief:

Who's the primary target for the ads/marketing copy? Same audience as the website (local directors, community leaders, stretched-thin operators), or are you going after a different segment?

A few directions to react to:

Punchy and direct (short sentences, bold claims, zero fluff)

Conversational and warm (feels like a text from a smart friend)

Problem-first urgency (leads with the pain, then the relief)

Any brands or ads you've seen lately that felt right? Even outside your industry — just something that made you think "that's the energy."

I don't have an official target audience at this point, but my ideal client is local small businesses, artisan, mom and pop, between the ages of 30 to 55 probably, maybe a little bit older, and somewhat informed in technology, but don't have enough time to actually implement.

Time-poor, tech-aware, local business owners who know they need a digital presence but can't execute it themselves. That's a very specific pain point to write to.

Here's what I'm thinking for the interview direction:

We'd explore three angles:

The frustration they feel - what does it actually look like when a local business owner is drowning in the digital side of running their shop

What your service actually relieves - not features, but the feeling of handing it off to someone who gets it

Your tone with these clients - how do you actually talk to a 47-year-old bakery owner vs. a city director? There's probably a real difference there worth capturing

The goal is to pull out the raw, unfiltered way you describe your work to real people, not the polished website version. That's where the marketing voice lives. Could you? Conduct. A. Series of questions? To. Help me re. Brand or to extend the brand voice for marketing-specifically. As I said above, I don't think the website voice of the. Art gallery security guard meets Wes

Anderson is really necessary for all situations, and honestly, it's just kind of a lot sometimes to continue talking like that. So— I'm looking to establish something a bit easier to use that is a bit more relatable. I don't want it to be too intense, just a few questions to help you come up with a new brand voice for an additional. Brand voice. To. Store here. And then I would like to. Look at the campaign. That I've attached. And start coming up with content.

Absolutely — and yes, we can make this much easier to use for ads and campaign copy.

Your current website voice is strong, but it sounds like a **primary brand voice**: polished, clever, a little architectural, and very intentional. For marketing copy, I'd recommend creating a **secondary voice** that keeps the competence but loosens the collar — more human, more immediate, less “brand system,” more “I know exactly what you need and I can help.” The current design system already frames the core voice as “sharp, straight-talking tech guy you actually want to call,” with a tone that is mostly casual, dry, plain, and confident. It also explicitly favors plain language, first-person singular, direct address, and “no jargon, no fluff”.
[1] [2]

Proposed secondary voice

I'd build the marketing voice around this idea:

Clear, capable, and relatable. Less clever. More useful.

That means:

- Still smart, but less formal.
- Still direct, but warmer and faster.
- Still trustworthy, but easier to skim in an ad.
- Still local-business-friendly, but not overdesigned or overly literary.

A simple way to think about it:

Voice layer	Website voice	Marketing voice
Tone	Polished, exact, distinctive	Friendly, plainspoken, quicker
Energy	Considered and controlled	More conversational and immediate
Humor	Dry and subtle	Light, human, occasional
Complexity	Slightly elevated	Low-friction and scannable
Goal	Establish authority	Create recognition and response

The existing brand already has the bones of this because it rejects jargon and favors straightforward statements like “Your apps talk to each other. You don’t have to.” and “Strategy is free. Execution is paid.” The marketing voice just needs to be a little less ceremonial and a little more “this solves your problem today.”
[1]

A voice charter

Here's a draft you can store as the secondary marketing voice:

Secondary Voice: The Helpful Local Expert

This voice sounds like the person in town who actually understands how small businesses work. It's calm, practical, and easy to trust. It doesn't try to impress people; it tries to help them move faster, look better, and stop losing time on digital busywork.

What it should feel like

- Helpful, not hyped.
- Local, not parochial.
- Smart, not technical.
- Friendly, not overly familiar.
- Confident, not salesy.

What it should sound like

- "Need a site that doesn't turn into a second job?"
- "You've got a business to run. We'll handle the digital part."
- "Good design is nice. Clear results are better."
- "If your website is making updates harder, that's the problem."

What it should avoid

- Overly poetic phrasing.
- Long metaphors.
- Bureau-style naming in every ad.
- Anything that sounds like a manifesto.
- Too much inside-baseball technical language.

Service-offering tone

For the service offerings specifically, I'd shift from the internal "department" language to a version that is still polished but more conversational. The internal definitions already describe each service in plain terms and emphasize what the client gets, which is exactly the right foundation. For marketing, the task is to make each offer feel like relief, not administration. ^[2]

Here's the pattern I'd use:

Service = pain point + outcome + reassurance

Example structure:

- What's hard right now.
- What you do to fix it.
- Why it feels easier after.

Service voice samples

Website / design

- "A website that looks professional and is easy to update."
- "Clean, clear design without the headache."
- "Your site should help people trust you, not confuse them."

Integrations

- "Make your tools work together so you can stop double-entering everything."
- "Less copy-paste. More getting things done."
- "Connect the systems you already use."

SEO / AEO

- "Help people find you when they're already looking."
- "Show up in search without writing like a robot."
- "Make your site easier to understand for both people and search."

Automation

- "Take the repetitive stuff off your plate."
- "Set it once. Stop doing it five times."
- "More time for the work only you can do."

Support / monitoring

- "Keep the site running, updated, and watched."
- "Someone's keeping an eye on it so you don't have to."
- "When something breaks, it doesn't become your afternoon."

How to use it in ads

Ads should sound more like a conversation than a description. That means shorter sentences, sharper hooks, and less internal branding language. The service can still feel premium, but the first job is to make someone think, "That's me," not "That's elegant."

A useful ad formula:

1. Name the problem.

2. Call out the pain in plain language.
3. Offer the relief.
4. End with a simple next step.

Example:

- “Running your business is enough. Your website shouldn’t be another job.”
- “If your tools don’t talk to each other, you’re paying the copy-paste tax.”
- “Need a site that looks good and doesn’t demand constant babysitting?”

Suggested next step

The strongest move now is to create a small **brand voice split**:

- **Website voice**: the polished, distinctive, brand-forward version.
- **Marketing voice**: the simpler, friendlier, more immediate version.

For the marketing voice, I’d keep the core promise from the current system — expert help, plain language, no fluff — and dial down the stylistic density. That gives you consistency without forcing every ad to sound like a design manifesto. [\[2\]](#) [\[1\]](#)

Questions to lock it in

Answer these, and I can turn this into a usable voice guide plus campaign copy:

1. Should the marketing voice feel more **friendly** or more **authoritative**?
2. Should it lean more **local and neighborly** or more **professional and polished**?
3. How much humor is okay: **none, light, or occasional**?
4. Should the voice sound more like “I” or more like “we” in ads?
5. Do you want the marketing voice to keep any of the current brand’s clever naming, or strip that back almost entirely?

If you want, I can turn this into a one-page secondary voice guide next, then draft the first ad concepts from your attached campaign.



1. Digital-Allies-Design-System.pdf
2. DA_Service_Definitions.docx
3. DA_Mohave_County_Market_Data.docx
4. DA_Accessibility_Summary_and_Statement.docx
5. DA_Bilingual_Translation_Policy.docx
6. pasted-text.txt